

6. Boughton Island

Shoreline length: 16 km



Shore Types

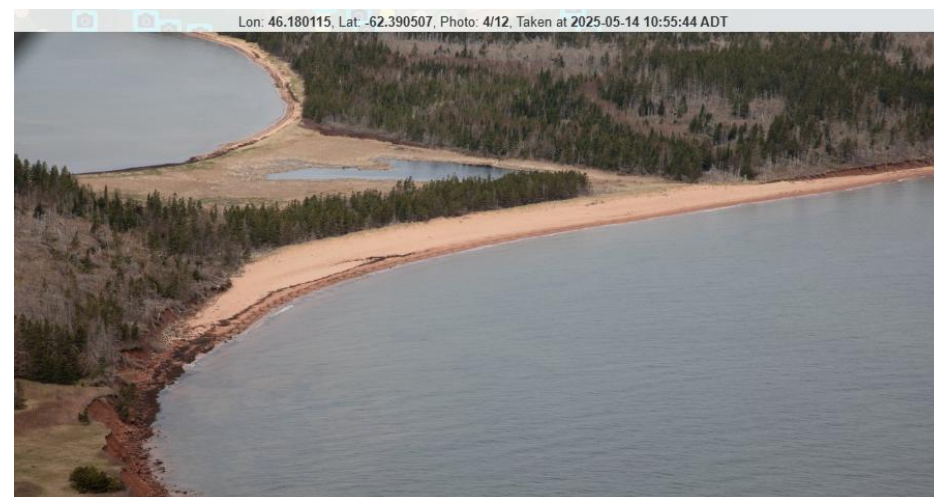
Boughton Island is at the entrance of Cardigan estuary. It is connected to the mainland by a barrier beach providing sheltering to Launching Bay. Main shore types are sand dunes and low plains.

% Shore types within SMU

low plain	bluff	sloped armour	cliff	wetland	vertical struct.	dunes	sandspit
24	10	0	16	16	0	34	0



North end of barrier dune to Boughton Island - Source: CHRIS



South cliffs and barrier dune on Boughton Island - Source: CHRIS

Governance, Infrastructure, and Economy

Boughton Island is almost entirely unincorporated; roughly 2% falls within the Town of Three Rivers. The island is owned by the Government of Prince Edward Island. The island is accessed only through a single point connecting to Bruce Point Road; all roads are unpaved, and this sole access point is a flood hazard risk. There is no alternate land access. There are no coastal economic drivers and no legacy development constraints noted.

Natural Assets and Heritage

Boughton Island is protected under the Natural Areas Protection Act and is home to the Boughton Island Nature Preserve. It is frequently visited by hikers. The shoreline includes critical habitat for bird species including the endangered Piping Plover and threatened Bank Swallow.

Planning and Policy Framework

Provincial rules apply except for the small stretch of shore located within Three Rivers. Under provincial development standards, which include horizontal coastal building setbacks based on edge of feature and a calculation of erosion over time, building setbacks for dunes, and a requirement for a coastal buffer for new subdivisions. There are no specific flood elevations identified in regulations, but coastal hazard assessments are typically conducted.

Coastal Flood and Erosion Risk

There is no infrastructure on the barrier or island.

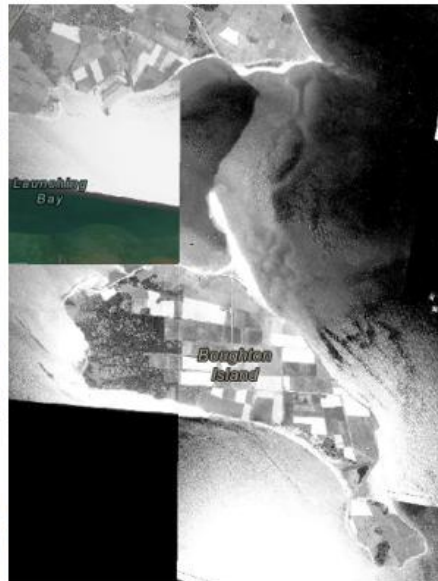
Sediment Transport and Morphology

Sediment transport is highest along the exposed sand dunes and wetlands and feeds the barrier beaches. There have been instances of the island being separated from the mainland, as seen in the historical air photos. The breach as since closed with natural sand supply from northward transport from the island connecting with southward transport from Launching Point on the mainland. Maintaining natural supply is critical to the future resilience against storm breaches.

1765



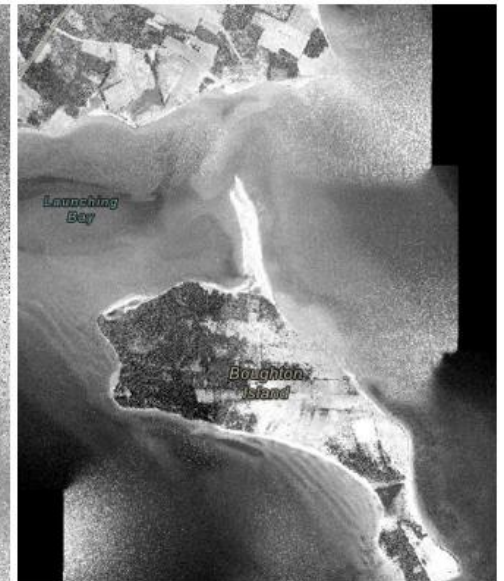
1935



1958



1968



Proposed SMP Strategies

	Short-term	Medium-term	Long-term
Sea level rise range	0 – 0.3 m	0.3 – 0.6 m	0.6 – 1.2 m
Potential timeframe	2030 - 2050	2050 - 2080	2080 - 2130
6.00 Boughton Island	NAI	NAI	NAI
Rationale	The primary strategy for Boughton Island is No Active Intervention as the local shoreline and hazard zone should remain natural, undeveloped. It is possible that the barrier beach may migrate west overtime. Maintaining natural sediment supply will be critical to minimize the risk of breaches and maintain wave sheltering for Launching Bay.		

The table above shows how the recommended shoreline management unit (SMU) or policy unit (PU) strategy evolves across three planning epochs (Short-, Medium-, and Long-term) under increasing sea-level rise and erosion projections.

Adaptation strategies are preliminary recommendations subject to further development with feedback from community and government. These strategies are not approvals, commitments or policy determinations.